What does this mean?

Back-up: The essential job of saving and storing data on a tape, CD-R, etc.

Copy Protection: Both discs and players come equipped with hardware mechanisms to prevent the illegal copying of DVDs. You will not be able to copy the movie to a VHS tape, your computer's hard drive or any other data-recording device.

DAT: Digital Audio Tape is a compact, high capacity form of data storage, suitable for archiving or backing up large amounts of data.

DVD: Digital Versatile Disc is a high-density format for playing full-motion video. It provides a vast data storage capacity. Although popular within the home market, DVDs can also be used to hold computer data.

Hybrid DVDs: Nine leading consumer electronics manufacturers have jointly issued the basic specifications for a next-generation, large-capacity optical disc video recording format called Blu-ray disc. These DVDs can hold six times the data held by those of the current standard. The new format will store more than 13 hours of film, compared to the current limit of 133 minutes.

High Density-DVD is the enhanced form of current DVD format. Blue lasers have a much shorter wavelength than the red lasers used in current DVD players, allowing for much greater disc capacity. The new high definition format allows a capacity of 4.7 GB to 15 GB on a single-sided, single-layered disc and a capacity of 8.5 GB to 30 GB on a single-sided, double-layered disc.

This provides a cost-effective upgrade path for media vendors and a backward-compatible solution for all those who've already built DVD libraries. Current DVD players use 650 nanometre (nm) red lasers, while CD players use 780 nm diodes. It will not be possible to play Blue-ray discs with existing DVD and CD players, since these don't use 405 nm lasers. Blue-ray drives need to contain 780, 650 and 405 nm lasers in order to be compatible with CD and DVD discs.

Packet writing: Packet writing is a technique by which a normal CD-R or CD-RW can be used like a floppy or zip drive. Normally, when a CD is burned, the table of contents (ToC) is generated first, then the burning begins, and finally the ToC is written onto it. This allows the OS to retrieve the files from the CD the way it is meant to be, but once the ToC is burnt in, more data can't be written onto the CD.

The idea behind packet writing is that if one need not worry about the TOC, and write data to a CD-R in blocks or packets. By writing an appropriate set of functions into the OS, a vendor can provide packet capability for writers with suitable hardware and firmware.

However, since the ToC will not be present, its information has to be conveyed to the OS in